



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: BRAVE Academy

School Website: <https://braveacademy.online/ba/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX)

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School's public materials consistently articulate a classical, Christian vision: a mission to "glorify Jesus Christ," the cultivation of "wise, virtuous, and humble" students, and an education oriented to "truth, goodness, and beauty." They implement the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, extensive primary sources, Socratic discussion, recitation and chanting in the lower grades, and a capstone senior thesis with oral defense. Daily chapel, explicit Christian studies, and an integrated curriculum "under the sovereignty of God through theology" are prominent. The collaborative (co-teacher) model demonstrates a deep partnership with parents through required co-teacher training and regular support. Evidence across all six elements is strong and unambiguous.

Method note: This audit applies the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" keyword framework (positive/negative indicators by category) as the scoring backbone, supplemented by the lexicon file.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords/phrases present (from school site)

- Transcendental moral realism: "truth, goodness, and beauty"; "True, the Good, and the Beautiful"; "wise, virtuous" and "humble" students.
- Grounded in theology: "under the sovereignty of God through theology"; "Christian education"; explicit Christian Studies (Exegesis & Hermeneutics; Development of Christian Doctrine & Church History; Apologetics & Ethics).
- Liturgical/communal practices: "begin each on-campus instructional day with Chapel"; All-School chapel noted on campus tours; "offer the work of the school as a prayer to Almighty God."

2) Mapping to Six Elements keywords

- Positive indicators matched: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; Christian; chapel; prayer; worshipful posture.
- Negative indicators: none observed (e.g., "values-neutral," "secular" absent).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits approx.: 12 (truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, wisdom, theology, Christian, chapel, prayer, etc.).
- Negative hits: 0.
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage of sub-elements (moral realism, theology, liturgical life): 100%

4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Clear, repeated language of transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, and daily chapel.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords/phrases present

- Aim: "To cultivate wisdom and virtue so that the love of God may abound more and more."
- Formation vs. information: "less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose"; "not a traditional college preparatory institution... our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life."
- Transcendentals: "contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful."

2) Mapping to Six Elements keywords

- Positive indicators matched: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation language; de-emphasis of "college and career readiness" as a primary telos.
- Negative indicators: none (workforce-first framing absent).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~9
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage (all three goal statements): 100%

4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Purpose is explicitly teleological and virtue-centric.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keywords/phrases present

- Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric explicitly taught and staged; formal logic begins in 8th; rhetoric in 10th; senior thesis with oral defense.
- Great Books/primary sources: "great works of the Western tradition"; "extensive primary source reading."
- Latin/classical languages: Latin grades 5–8 minimum; up to Latin IV; National Latin Exam results.
- Integrated/harmony of subjects: "interrelation of all knowledge... under the sovereignty of God through theology"; intentional integration in daily schedule.
- History (not "social studies"): dedicated "History" sequencing and capstone DC trip tied to U.S. History.

2) Mapping to Six Elements keywords

- Positive matches: trivium, Latin, great books/primary sources, integrated approach, history sequence; rhetoric thesis.
- Negative indicators (e.g., STEM-first, social-studies framing, project-dominance): not observed.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~12
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage (liberal arts, great books, harmony of subjects, integration/wonder): 90–100% (explicit “wonder” term is rare; integration is strong)

4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Content and structure are textbook classical.
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

1) Keywords/phrases present

- Lower school memory/recitation/chanting/singing: “Teachers employ... memorization, recitation, and songs”; “Songs, chants, and rhymes fill our grammar school.”
- Socratic/dialectic: “Socratic discussion”; debate/discussion in logic years.
- Rhetoric/oratory: “year-long senior thesis... oral presentation and defense.”
- Restful learning/schol  cues: “education is also a type of play... at leisure to study and to play.”

2) Mapping to Six Elements keywords

- Positive matches: memorization/recitation/chanting; Socratic discussion; rhetoric oration/defense; restful tone.
- Negative indicators (project-only, student-directed, constructivist dominance): not observed.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~10
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage (memory/chant, Socratic, rhetoric/orations, restful learning): 100%

4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Strong evidence across the classical pedagogy arc, K–12.
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CATEGORY 5: FACULTY

1) Keywords/phrases present

- Teachers as models/mentors: “All our teachers... are professed Christians... model proper behavior... subject-matter experts... train and observe our teachers diligently... ongoing educational opportunities... humble reliance on His provision... offer the work... as a prayer to Almighty God.”
- Faculty commitments: teachers provide weekly plans; office hours to support students/parents; clear expectations and standards.

2) Mapping to Six Elements keywords

- Positive matches: teachers as moral exemplars, mentors, “living curriculum” posture implied; formation-minded faculty culture.
- Negative indicators: “facilitators/guides on the side” language absent.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~6
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage (model virtue, mentorship/collegiality, portrait/profile): ~70% (strong modeling/training; no stand-alone “portrait of a teacher” page found)

4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Evidence of teachers as exemplars with ongoing formation and high standards.
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CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords/phrases present

- Partnership with parents/co-teachers: “co-laboring with families”; co-teacher model described in detail; mandatory co-teacher training; teacher office hours; “we are in this together.”
- Parent education & access: “prospective parent events,” tours begin with All-School chapel; regular communications/support structures.
- Community life: House System; athletics and arts; recitatio; community events and traditions.

2) Mapping to Six Elements keywords

- Positive matches: partnership with families, parental primacy (co-teaching), intentional community practices.
- Negative indicators: “parents as customers only” absent.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~10
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage (parent partnership, parent formation, open welcome): 100%

4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. The collaborative model centers parental partnership and formation.
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Aggregate Classification

- Overall: CLASSICAL
 - Rationale: Strong positive keyword density and full coverage of all six elements. The school’s own language and program design exemplify classical Christian education, including daily chapel, Trivium sequencing, Latin, Great Books/primary sources, Socratic pedagogy, rhetoric orations, and robust parent partnership.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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